SUBJECT GUIDE

Geography — physical, Indian & world

From the Earth's interior to India's resources, with maps and environment.

11	34	61
Modules	Topics	NCERT chapters

Asked in: UPSC · State PSC · SSC · Railway · Defence · TET/TRE

Contents

1 The Earth & the universe
2 Landforms & geomorphology
3 Atmosphere & climate
4 Oceans
5 India — location & physiography
6 India — climate, soils & vegetation
7 Resources, agriculture, minerals & industry
8 Population & settlements
9 Economic activities, transport & trade
10 World geography & maps
11 Environment, biodiversity & disasters

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MODULE 1

The Earth & the universe

- ☐ Solar system, latitudes & longitudes
- ☐ Origin & interior of the Earth
- ☐ Continents & oceans, plate tectonics

How it's asked: Layers of the Earth and their depths/compositions are frequent one-liners.

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NCERT Class 6 · Introduction & Locating Places on the Earth · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 6 · Oceans and Continents · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 11 · The Origin and Evolution of the Earth · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 11 · Interior of the Earth · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 11 · Distribution of Oceans and Continents · PDF ↗

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MODULE 2

Landforms & geomorphology

- ☐ Weathering, erosion, deposition
- ☐ Rivers, glaciers, wind & coastal landforms
- ☐ Mountains, plateaus, plains

How it's asked: Landform ↔ agent (e.g. delta–river, moraine–glacier).

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

NCERT Class 6 · Landforms and Life · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 11 · Geomorphic Processes · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 11 · Landforms and their Evolution · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 7 · Inside Our Earth · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 7 · Our Changing Earth · PDF ↗

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MODULE 3

Atmosphere & climate

- ☐ Layers & composition of the atmosphere
- ☐ Humidity, clouds, precipitation
- ☐ Insolation, pressure belts, winds
- ☐ World climates & climate change

How it's asked: Layer ↔ feature (ozone in stratosphere), local winds ↔ region.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

NCERT Class 11 · Composition and Structure of Atmosphere · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 11 · Solar Radiation, Heat Balance and Temperature · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 11 · Atmospheric Circulation and Weather Systems · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 11 · Water in the Atmosphere · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 11 · World Climate and Climate Change · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 7 · Understanding the Weather · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 7 · Air · PDF ↗

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MODULE 4

Oceans

- ☐ Ocean relief, temperature, salinity
- ☐ Currents, tides, waves

How it's asked: Warm vs cold currents and where they flow.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 11 · Water (Oceans) · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 11 · Movements of Ocean Water · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · Water · PDF ↗

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MODULE 5

India — location & physiography

- ☐ Location, neighbours, states
- ☐ Himalaya, plains, plateau, coasts, islands
- ☐ Drainage: Himalayan & peninsular rivers

How it's asked: River ↔ origin ↔ tributaries and passes ↔ states are asked every year.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 11 · India – Location · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 11 · Structure and Physiography · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 11 · Drainage System · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · Geographical Diversity of India · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · India and Her Neighbours · PDF ↗

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MODULE 6

India — climate, soils & vegetation

- ☐ Monsoon mechanism & seasons
- ☐ Soil types & their regions
- ☐ Natural vegetation & wildlife

How it's asked: Soil ↔ crop ↔ region and forest type ↔ rainfall.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 11 · Climate · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 11 · Natural Vegetation · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · Climates of India · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · Land, Soil, Water, Natural Vegetation and Wildlife Resources · PDF ↗

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MODULE 7

Resources, agriculture, minerals & industry

- ☐ Land & water resources
- ☐ Crops, seasons, revolutions in agriculture
- ☐ Minerals & energy
- ☐ Industries & their locations

How it's asked: Largest producer state of a crop/mineral is a top question.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

NCERT Class 10 · Resources and Development · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 10 · Forest and Wildlife Resources · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 10 · Water Resources · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 10 · Agriculture · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 10 · Minerals and Energy Resources · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 10 · Manufacturing Industries · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Land Resources and Agriculture · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Water Resources · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Mineral and Energy Resources · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 8 · Agriculture · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 8 · Industries · PDF ↗

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MODULE 8

Population & settlements

- ☐ Census facts: density, sex ratio, literacy
- ☐ Migration & urbanisation
- ☐ Human settlements

How it's asked: Census ranking questions (highest/lowest state) — use the official Census site.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

NCERT Class 12 · The World Population: Distribution, Density and Growth · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Human Development · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Population: Distribution, Density, Growth and Composition · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Human Settlements · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 8 · Dynamics of Population · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 8 · India's Urban Landscape · PDF ↗

OFFICIAL Census of India ↗

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MODULE 9

Economic activities, transport & trade

- ☐ Primary to quaternary activities
- ☐ International trade
- ☐ Roads, railways, ports, airports

How it's asked: Longest/first transport facts and major ports ↔ states.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

NCERT Class 12 · Primary Activities · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Secondary Activities · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Tertiary and Quaternary Activities · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Transport and Communication · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · International Trade · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Transport and Communication · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · International Trade · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 10 · Lifelines of National Economy · PDF ↗

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MODULE 10

World geography & maps

- ☐ Continents, major regions
- ☐ Map-based location questions
- ☐ Deserts, grasslands, major rivers

How it's asked: Keep a blank map and mark straits, deserts and rivers as you read.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

NCERT Class 8 · World Geography: Some Glimpses · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 7 · Human Environment Interactions: The Tropical and the Subtropical Region · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 7 · Life in the Deserts · PDF ↗

OFFICIAL ISRO Bhuvan (maps) ↗

OFFICIAL Survey of India ↗

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MODULE 11

Environment, biodiversity & disasters

- ☐ Ecosystems, biodiversity hotspots
- ☐ Protected areas & conservation
- ☐ Natural hazards & disaster management

How it's asked: National park ↔ state and Ramsar/biosphere facts appear in every GA section.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 11 · Biodiversity and Conservation · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 11 · Natural Hazards and Disasters · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · Natural Resources and Their Use · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 10 · Forest and Wildlife Resources · PDF ↗
- NIOS NIOS Geography (316) ↗

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